

Of course, MIDI wouldn't be fun if you needed a real live musical instrument to create your music, now, would it? You don't need to tinker around with hardware every time—you can choose from a wide range of software to begin creating and editing MIDI sequences, or you can use VST instruments (which we talked about in chapter 8) with your preferred audio editing program.

9.2 Software

Nearly all MIDI creation software offer you a virtual music keyboard of your own. All you need to do to use these are load up a sample instrument and play away! Here are some essential programs to get you started with creating your own MIDI sequences.

FL Studio

This incredibly powerful mixer is also quite capable of creating some really awesome MIDI tracks. And unlike other programs that let you play only one note at a time, FL Studio's unique and user-friendly Piano Roll lets you easily create chords and other effects such as gliding over the keys of the keyboard. It



FL Studio—the incredible MIDI maker

also comes loaded with a bunch of VST instruments, offering a mind-boggling variety of instrument samples. After you've used it for a while, the \$99 (Rs 4,300) price tag appears surprisingly small.

Cakewalk Sonar 5

Cakewalk, too, has been a leader in the world of music creation. Sonar 5 is practically a whole recording studio inside your humble PC—from sequencing MIDI to processing effects.



Cakewalk's incredible Sonar